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November 12, 2025

Anthropic IT Team
San Francisco, CA

Dear Anthropic IT Team,

I'm excited to apply for the IT Support Specialist role because your job description describes exactly how I already think about technical support. When I encounter a problem, I fix it. But I'm also immediately thinking "why did this happen and how do I prevent it from happening again?" That mindset has shaped my entire career, from my 4 years doing enterprise support at SimpleCast to the past decade building and maintaining my own infrastructure while helping thousands of technical users solve problems.

Here's what makes me a good fit: I've done real IT support AND I build real infrastructure. At SimpleCast/SiriusXM, I supported 100+ enterprise clients through complex technical issues, worked directly with engineering teams via Jira and Slack, and created documentation that prevented the same problems from happening repeatedly. But I've also spent the past decade building and maintaining production systems. I run VPS servers with Docker containers, PostgreSQL databases, and self-hosted applications. I write Python scripts to automate repetitive tasks. I've configured firewalls, troubleshoot networking issues, and debugged authentication problems. When someone on your team mentions a Docker networking conflict or a database connection timeout, I immediately understand what they're talking about because I've fixed those exact issues myself.

I'm also comfortable with the AI-specific challenges your team faces. I work with LLM APIs constantly (OpenAI, Claude, Gemini), troubleshoot vector database configurations, deploy local models through Ollama, and help people debug their AI integrations every day. Through my YouTube channel (41,500+ subscribers), I help developers and AI enthusiasts solve novel technical problems. These aren't typical help desk tickets. People come to me when they're stuck on cutting-edge tools that have barely any documentation yet. I've gotten good at reading error logs, understanding what's actually breaking, and explaining solutions clearly.

What I appreciate about this role is that you're not looking for someone who just handles tickets. You want someone who thinks strategically about preventing problems. That's exactly what I do. When I see the same issue multiple times, I build automation. I create self-service tools. I write documentation that helps people solve problems without needing to open a ticket. Over the years, I've created 1,500+ tutorials and guides that have eliminated countless support requests by teaching people how to troubleshoot issues themselves.

I'm honest about what I don't know yet. I haven't administered enterprise-level IAM systems or worked with MDM platforms like Jamf. I understand Docker but haven't used Kubernetes in production. But I learn quickly through hands-on experience. That's how I've picked up everything else—by encountering problems, reading documentation, experimenting, and figuring things out. When I run into something new, I don't panic. I dig in and learn it.

I'm ready to relocate to SF and work onsite 4-5 days per week. I know some of the best IT work happens when you can walk over to someone's desk, see their actual setup, and troubleshoot together. That kind of collaboration is hard to replicate remotely.

I think I'd be a good addition to your team because I bring both the technical skills to solve hard problems and the strategic thinking to prevent them from happening again. I'd love the chance to discuss how I can contribute to supporting Anthropic's mission.

Thanks for considering my application.

Best regards,

Mike Murphy